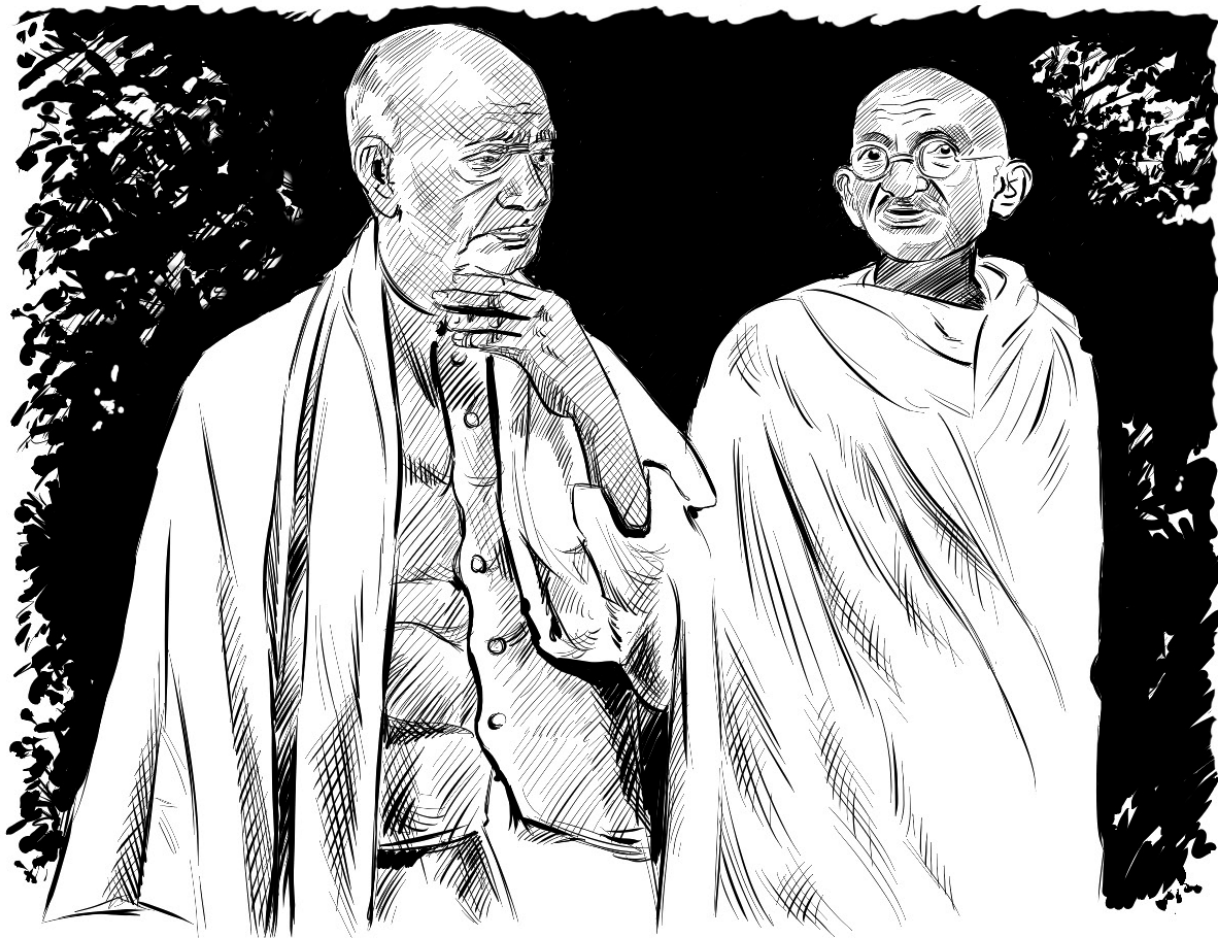


Gandhi was still concerned for the leadership of India. Nehru was now prime minister, and Patel was deputy prime minister. But the two did not always get along. Gandhi wrote to Nehru to tell him that they must work together. On January 30, 1948, he met with Patel and urged him to do the same.

He left the dinner with Patel to lead a prayer meeting. He was now almost eighty years old. His body was weak from his fasts and he had trouble walking, so he leaned on two of his followers for support. He walked out to greet the crowd of about five hundred.